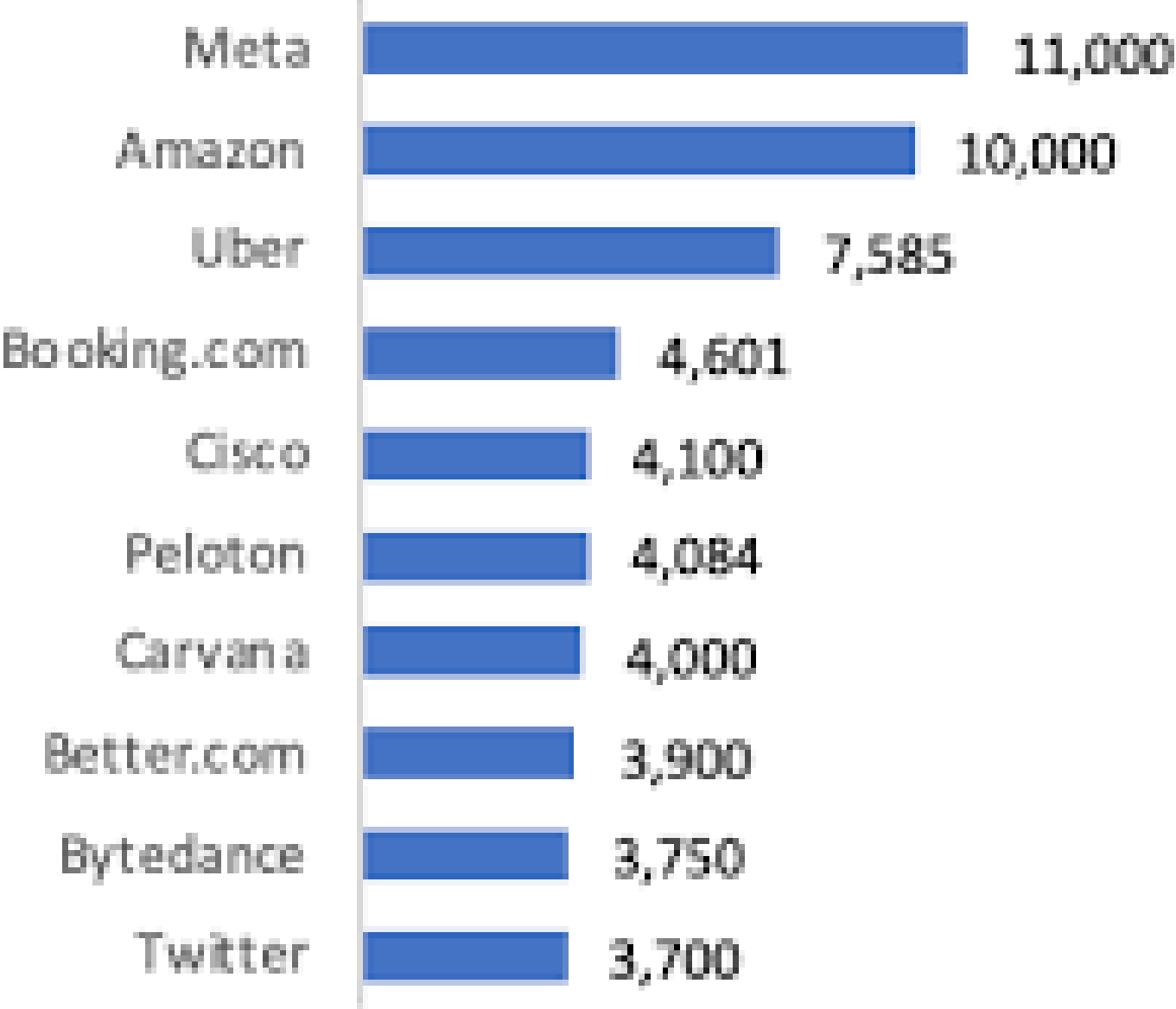


THE
WORLD
LAYOFF
PROJECT

Top 10 Layoff Companies



Project Overview

In this project, we analyzed global layoff data to uncover trends, patterns, and financial implications. Our goal was to understand not just how many people were laid off, but why—exploring the relationships between company size, industry, funding, and timing.

Key Steps:

Data Cleaning: Ensured data integrity by removing duplicates, standardizing formats, and handling null values.

Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA): Explored minimum/maximum layoff percentages, identified companies with full layoffs, and examined financial ties between funding and workforce changes.

Insights: Revealed industry trends, annual layoff distributions, and month-over-month shifts to guide workforce and investment strategies.

Initial Dataset Snapshot (Before Cleaning)

A raw view of the dataset revealed inconsistencies and missing fields—hindering analysis. Cleaning was essential for reliable insights.

company	location	industry	total_laid_off	percentag
Tricida	SF Bay Area	Healthcare	NULL	0.57
Veev	SF Bay Area	Real Estate	100	0.3
Forto	Berlin	Logistics	60	0.08
Chipax	Santiago	Finance	NULL	NULL
Juniper	Atlanta	Marketing	NULL	NULL
Offerpad	Phoenix	Real Estate	NULL	0.07
GoTo Group	Jakarta	Transportation	1300	0.12
Juul	SF Bay Area		400	0.3
Blend	SF Bay Area	Finance	100	0.06
InfluxData	SF Bay Area	Data	65	0.27
Coinbase	SF Bay Area	Crypto	60	NULL
SoundHound	SF Bay Area	Other	45	0.1
Wistia	Boston	Marketing	40	NULL

company	location	industry	total_laid_off	percentage_laid_off	date	stage	country	funds_raised_millions	row_nu
Casper	New York City	Retail	NULL	NULL	9/14/2021	Post-IPO	United States	339	2
Cazoo	London	Transportation	750	0.15	6/7/2022	Post-IPO	United Kingdom	2000	2
Hibob	Tel Aviv	HR	70	0.3	3/30/2020	Series A	Israel	45	2
Wildlife Studios	Sao Paulo	Consumer	300	0.2	11/28/2022	Unknown	Brazil	260	2
Yahoo	SF Bay Area	Consumer	1600	0.2	2/9/2023	Acquired	United States	6	2

Cleaned Dataset Snapshot (After Cleaning)

Post-cleaning, the dataset was standardized and ready for meaningful exploration and visualization.

	company	location	industry	total_laid_off	percentage_laid_off	date	stage	country	fund:
▶	Included Health	SF Bay Area	Healthcare	NULL	0.06	2022-07-25	Series E	United States	272
	&Open	Dublin	Marketing	9	0.09	2022-11-17	Series A	Ireland	35
	#Paid	Toronto	Marketing	19	0.17	2023-01-27	Series B	Canada	21
	100 Thieves	Los Angeles	Consumer	12	NULL	2022-07-13	Series C	United States	120
	10X Genomics	SF Bay Area	Healthcare	100	0.08	2022-08-04	Post-IPO	United States	242
	1stdibs	New York City	Retail	70	0.17	2020-04-02	Series D	United States	253
	2TM	Sao Paulo	Crypto	90	0.12	2022-06-01	Unknown	Brazil	250
	2TM	Sao Paulo	Crypto	100	0.15	2022-09-01	Unknown	Brazil	250
	2U	Washington D.C.	Education	NULL	0.2	2022-07-28	Post-IPO	United States	426
	54gene	Washington D.C.	Healthcare	95	0.3	2022-08-29	Series B	United States	44
	5B Solar	Sydney	Energy	NULL	0.25	2022-06-03	Series A	Australia	12
	6sense	SF Bay Area	Sales	150	0.1	2022-10-12	Series E	United States	426
	80 Acres Farms	Cincinnati	Food	NULL	0.1	2023-01-18	Unknown	United States	275
	8x8	SF Bay Area	Support	155	0.07	2023-01-18	Post-IPO	United States	253
	8x8	SF Bay Area	Support	200	0.09	2022-10-04	Post-IPO	United States	253
	98point6	Seattle	Healthcare	NULL	0.1	2022-07-21	Series E	United States	247
	99	Sao Paulo	Transport...	75	0.02	2022-09-20	Acquired	Brazil	244

Data Queries & Insights

1. Layoff Percentages – How Big Were These Layoffs?

```
World Layoffs Data Cleaning | Exploratory Data Analysis of Wo... | layoffs_staging2 | layoffs_staging2 | SQL File 5
```

```
5
6  -- 1. Looking at Percentage to see how big these layoffs were
7
8  • SELECT MIN(percentage_laid_off) AS minimum_percentage_laidOff, MAX(percentage_laid_off) AS maximum_percentage_laidOff
9     FROM layoffs_staging2
10    WHERE percentage_laid_off IS NOT NULL;
```

```
Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export: | Wrap Cell Content: |
```

	minimum_percentage_laidOff	maximum_percentage_laidOff
▶	0	1

This revealed the severity of workforce reductions—highlighting that many companies laid off a significant percentage of employees, not just headcount. It exposed business fragility and strategic shifts.

2. Which Companies Had 100% Layoffs?

```
12  -- 2. Which companies had 1 which is basically 100 percent of the company laid off
13
14  •  SELECT *
15     FROM layoffs_staging2
16     WHERE percentage_laid_off = 1
17     ORDER BY total_laid_off desc;
```

	company	location	industry	total_laid_off	percentage	date	stage	country	funds_raised_millions
►	Katterra	SF Bay Area	Construction	2434	1	2021-06-01	Unknown	United States	1600
	Butler Hospitality	New York City	Food	1000	1	2022-07-08	Series B	United States	50
	Deliv	SF Bay Area	Retail	669	1000	2020-05-13	Series C	United States	80
	Jump	New York City	Transportation	500	1	2020-05-07	Acquired	United States	11
	SEND	Sydney	Food	300	1	2022-05-04	Seed	Australia	3
	HOOQ	Singapore	Consumer	250	1	2020-03-27	Unknown	Singapore	95
	Stoqo	Jakarta	Food	250	1	2020-04-25	Series A	Indonesia	NULL
	Stay Alfred	Spokane	Travel	221	1	2020-05-20	Series B	United States	62
	Britishvolt	London	Transportation	206	1	2023-01-17	Unknown	United Kingdom	2400
	Planetly	Berlin	Other	200	1	2022-11-04	Acquired	Germany	5
	Crejo.Fun	Bengaluru	Education	170	1	2022-06-30	Seed	India	3
	Bridge Connector	Nashville	Healthcare	154	1	2020-11-17	Series B	United States	45
	Simple Feast	Copenhagen	Food	150	1	2022-09-07	Unknown	Denmark	173
	Realī	SF Bay Area	Real Estate	140	1	2022-08-24	Series B	United States	117
	Blueprint	Denver	Education	137	1	2020-05-26	Acquired	United States	108

Identifying companies that laid off 100% of their staff suggested total shutdowns. These were likely due to bankruptcies, failed pivots, or unsustainable business models—raising questions about resilience.

3. Top Companies by Funds Raised (Funds_Raised_Millions)

```
19  -- 3. if we order by funDs_raised_millions we can see how big some of these companies were
20  -- BritishVolt: Despite being in the promising EV sector, faced significant layoffs.
21  -- Quibi: Raised approximately $2 billion but ultimately ceased operations, leading to layoffs.
22
23  •  SELECT *
24     FROM layoffs_staging2
25     WHERE  percentage_laid_off = 1
26     ORDER BY funds_raised_millions DESC;
```

	company	location	industry	total_laid_off	percentage	date	stage	country	funds_raised_millions
►	Britishvolt	London	Transportation	206	1	2023-01-17	Unknown	United Kingdom	2400
	Quibi	Los Angeles	Media	NULL	1	2020-10-21	Private Equity	United States	1800
	Deliveroo Australia	Melbourne	Food	120	1	2022-11-15	Post-IPO	Australia	1700
	Katerra	SF Bay Area	Construction	2434	1	2021-06-01	Unknown	United States	1600
	BlockFi	New York City	Crypto	NULL	1	2022-11-28	Series E	United States	1000
	Aura Financial	SF Bay Area	Finance	NULL	1	2021-01-11	Unknown	United States	584
	Openpay	Melbourne	Finance	83	1	2023-02-07	Post-IPO	Australia	299
	Pollen	London	Marketing	NULL	1	2022-08-10	Series C	United Kingdom	238
	Simple Feast	Copenhagen	Food	150	1	2022-09-07	Unknown	Denmark	173
	Arch Oncology	Brisbane	Healthcare	NULL	1	2023-01-13	Series C	United States	155
	Motif Investing	SF Bay Area	Finance	NULL	1	2020-04-18	Series E	United States	126
	CommonBond	New York City	Finance	NULL	1	2022-09-09	Series D	United States	125
	Fast	SF Bay Area	Finance	NULL	1	2022-04-05	Series B	United States	124
	RealI	SF Bay Area	Real Estate	140	1	2022-08-24	Series B	United States	117
	The Wing	New York City	Real Estate	NULL	1	2022-08-31	Series C	United States	117

Companies that had raised the most capital yet still resorted to layoffs point to misaligned growth strategies or inefficient capital use. Funding doesn’t always mean stability.

4. Top 10 Companies with the Most Total Layoffs

World Layoffs Data Cleaning | Exploratory Data Analysis of Wo... | layoffs_staging2

          Don't Limit  

```
27
28  -- 4. Top 10 Companies with the most Total Layoffs
29
30 •  SELECT company, SUM(total_laid_off)
31     FROM layoffs_staging2
32     GROUP BY company
33     ORDER BY 2 desc
34     LIMIT 10;
35
```

Result Grid			Filter Rows:
	company	SUM(total_laid_off)	
▶	Amazon	18150	
	Google	12000	
	Meta	11000	
	Salesforce	10090	
	Microsoft	10000	
	Philips	10000	
	Ericsson	8500	
	Uber	7585	
	Dell	6650	
	Booking.com	4601	

This list highlighted the most impacted organizations. Often, these were large tech companies that grew rapidly during boom periods and scaled back aggressively post-growth.

5. ANNUAL LAYOFFS BY YEAR

```
World Layoffs Data Cleaning | Exploratory Data Analysis of Wo...  
[Icons: Folder, Save, Undo, Redo, Find, Stop, Run, Refresh, Close, Don't Limit]  
39      -- 5. Annual Layoffs by Year  
40  
41  •    SELECT YEAR(`date`), SUM(total_laid_off)  
42        FROM layoffs_staging2  
43        GROUP BY YEAR(`date`)  
44        ORDER BY 1 desc;  
45
```

Result Grid			Filter Rows:
	YEAR(`date`)	SUM(total_laid_off)	
▶	2023	125677	
	2022	160661	
	2021	15823	
	2020	80998	
	NULL	500	

Year-over-year analysis showed spikes in certain years—often aligning with global events like COVID-19 or market corrections. These trends offer macroeconomic context.

6. Layoffs per Company per Year

World Layoffs Data Cleaning | Exploratory Data Analysis of Wo... | layoffs_staging2 | layoffs_staging2 | SQL File 5

 Don't Limit

```
47  -- 6. Earlier we looked at Companies with the most Layoffs. Now let's look at that per year.
48
49  WITH Company_year AS (
50      SELECT company, YEAR(`date`) AS years, SUM(total_laid_off) AS total_laid_off
51      FROM layoffs_staging2
52      GROUP BY company, years
53  ),
54  Company_rank AS (
55      SELECT company, years, total_laid_off, DENSE_RANK() OVER (PARTITION BY years order BY total_laid_off DESC) AS ranking
56      FROM Company_year
57  )
58  SELECT company, years, total_laid_off, ranking
59  FROM Company_rank
60  WHERE years IS NOT NULL AND ranking <= 3;
61
```

Result Grid | Filter Rows: | Export:

	company	years	total_laid_off	ranking
▶	Uber	2020	7525	1
	Booking.com	2020	4375	2
	Groupon	2020	2800	3
	Bytedance	2021	3600	1
	Katerra	2021	2434	2
	Zillow	2021	2000	3
	Meta	2022	11000	1
	Amazon	2022	10150	2
	Cisco	2022	4100	3
	Google	2023	12000	1
	Microsoft	2023	10000	2
	Ericsson	2023	8500	3

This drilled down into annual layoff behavior at the company level, helping pinpoint which companies had recurring layoffs versus one-time actions—useful for risk analysis.

7. ROLLING TOTAL OF LAYOFFS PER MONTH

```

61
62 -- 7. Rolling Total of Layoffs Per Month
63
64 • WITH Monthly_total AS (
65     SELECT substring(`date`, 1, 7) AS months, SUM(total_laid_off) AS total_off
66     FROM layoffs_staging2
67     WHERE `date` is not null
68     GROUP BY months
69     ORDER BY months DESC)
70     SELECT months, total_off, SUM(total_off) OVER (ORDER BY months) AS rolling_total
71     FROM Monthly_total;

```

	months	total_off	rolling_total
▶	2020-03	9628	9628
	2020-04	26710	36338
	2020-05	25804	62142
	2020-06	7627	69769
	2020-07	7112	76881
	2020-08	1969	78850
	2020-09	609	79459
	2020-10	450	79909
	2020-11	237	80146
	2020-12	852	80998
	2021-01	6813	87811
	2021-02	868	88679
	2021-03	47	88726
	2021-04	261	88987
	2021-05	2424	91411

Result 68 ×

Rolling trends revealed layoff momentum—not just isolated events. This helped visualize how quickly workforce cuts spread across industries or slowed down.

8. PERCENTAGE CHANGE IN LAYOFFS BETWEEN TWO CONSECUTIVE MONTHS:

```
World Layoffs Data Cleaning | Exploratory Data Analysis of Wo... x | layoffs_staging2 | layoffs_staging2 | SQL File 5
[Icons] | Don't Limit | [Icons]
73  -- 8. Percentage Change in Layoffs Between Two Consecutive Months:
74
75  • WITH Monthly_total AS (
76      SELECT substring(`date`, 1, 7) AS months, SUM(total_laid_off) AS total_off
77      FROM layoffs_staging2
78      WHERE `date` is not null
79      GROUP BY months
80      ORDER BY months DESC),
81  Lagged_Summary AS(
82      SELECT months, total_off, LAG(total_off) OVER (ORDER BY months) AS previous_month_layoff
83      FROM Monthly_total
84  )
85  select months, total_off, previous_month_layoff, total_off - previous_month_layoff AS layoff_difference,
86  ROUND ( CASE WHEN previous_month_layoff = 0 THEN null
87      ELSE (total_off - previous_month_layoff)/ previous_month_layoff * 100
88  END, 2) AS percentage_change
89  FROM lagged_Summary
90  WHERE previous_month_layoff IS NOT NULL;
```

	months	total_off	previous_month_layoff	layoff_difference	percentage_change
▶	2020-04	26710	9628	17082	177.42
	2020-05	25804	26710	-906	-3.39
	2020-06	7627	25804	-18177	-70.44
	2020-07	7112	7627	-515	-6.75
	2020-08	1969	7112	-5143	-72.31
	2020-09	609	1969	-1360	-69.07
	2020-10	450	609	-159	-26.11
	2020-11	237	450	-213	-47.33
	2020-12	852	237	615	259.49
	2021-01	6813	852	5961	699.65
	2021-02	868	6813	-5945	-87.26
	2021-03	47	868	-821	-94.59
	2021-04	261	47	214	455.32
	2021-06	2434	261	2173	832.57
	2021-07	80	2434	-2354	-96.71
	2021-08	1867	80	1787	2233.75
	2021-09	161	1867	-1706	-91.38

Month-to-month changes showed how reactive industries were. Sudden spikes might correlate with market crashes or policy changes, while drops suggest stabilization.

9. Companies with High Funding but Still Layoffs

```

92  -- 9. Companies with Significant Funds Raised but Still Had Layoffs
93
94  •  SELECT
95      company,
96      location,
97      industry,
98      total_laid_off,
99      funds_raised_millions
100  FROM
101      layoffs_staging2
102  WHERE
103      funds_raised_millions > (SELECT
104          AVG(funds_raised_millions)
105      FROM
106          layoffs_staging2
107      WHERE
108          funds_raised_millions IS NOT NULL)
109      AND total_laid_off > 100;
110
```

	company	location	industry	total_laid_off	funds_raised_millions
▶	Affirm	SF Bay Area	Finance	500	1500
	Airbnb	SF Bay Area	Travel	1900	5400
	Airtable	SF Bay Area	Product	254	1400
	AppLovin	SF Bay Area	Marketing	300	1600
	Argo AI	Pittsburgh	Transportation	150	3600
	Argo AI	Pittsburgh	Transportation	173	3600
	Argo AI	SF Bay Area	Transportation	259	3600
	Better.com	New York City	Real Estate	900	905
	Better.com	New York City	Real Estate	3000	905
	BlockFi	New York City	Crypto	250	1000
	Bolt	SF Bay Area	Finance	240	1300
	Brex	SF Bay Area	Finance Finance	136	1500
	Britishvolt	London	Transportation	206	2400
	Byju's	Bengaluru	Education	1500	5500
	Byju's	Bengaluru	Education	2500	5500
	Bytedance	Mumbai	Consumer	1800	7400
	Bytedance	Shanghai	Consumer	150	9400
	Bytedance	Shanghai	Consumer	1800	9400
	Cars24	Gurugram	Transportation	600	1300
	Carvana	Phoenix	Transportation	2500	1600

A critical contrast—firms with ample financial resources still letting go of workers implies internal inefficiencies, poor forecasting, or strategic repositioning.

10. Average Funds Raised, Total Layoffs & Rank Difference by Industry

```
111 -- 10. Calculate Average Funds Raised, Total Layoffs, and Rank Difference by Industry
112
113 -- The rank_difference helps in understanding how industries fare
114 -- in terms of their financial health (funding) versus their workforce dynamics (layoffs).
115 -- A negative rank_difference generally indicates industries with lower layoffs relative to their funding,
116 -- suggesting stability or efficient management.
117 -- Conversely, a positive rank_difference may indicate industries with higher layoffs despite good funding,
118 -- highlighting potential challenges or inefficiencies in workforce management.
119
120 WITH IndustrySummary AS(
121   SELECT industry, AVG( funds_raised_millions ) AS average_funds, SUM( total_laid_off ) AS total_layoffs
122   FROM layoffs_staging2
123   WHERE funds_raised_millions IS NOT NULL AND total_laid_off IS NOT NULL
124   GROUP BY industry
125 ),
126 IndustryRank AS(
127   SELECT industry, average_funds, total_layoffs,
128   RANK() OVER(ORDER BY average_funds DESC) AS rank_fund,
129   RANK() OVER(ORDER BY total_layoffs DESC) AS rank_layoff
130   FROM IndustrySummary
131 )
132 SELECT industry, average_funds, total_layoffs, rank_fund, rank_layoff, CAST(rank_fund AS SIGNED) - CAST(rank_layoff AS SIGNED) AS rank_diff
133 FROM IndustryRank
134 ORDER BY rank_fund;
```

Result Grid



Filter Rows:

Export:



Wrap Cell Content:



	industry	average_funds	total_layoffs	rank_fund	rank_layoff	rank_difference
▶	Media	9401.6415	4572	1	17	-16
	Transportation	2439.8544	32900	2	4	-2
	Consumer	1793.2152	44037	3	1	2
	Real Estate	1274.0845	16675	4	7	-3
	Hardware	1034.8000	925	5	25	-20
	Food	1000.5543	22555	6	6	0
	Travel	823.5500	10381	7	11	-4
	Aerospace	775.5000	661	8	28	-20
	Fitness	502.8000	8698	9	13	-4
	Construction	489.0000	3863	10	19	-9
	Retail	471.7154	42342	11	2	9
	Finance	456.8737	24395	12	5	7
	Other	415.6087	34740	13	3	10
	Logistics	407.7931	3996	14	18	-4
	Education	380.6349	13125	15	10	5

Cross-industry analysis revealed which sectors were most vulnerable or resilient. For example, tech might raise more but lay off more, while healthcare or energy could show more stability.

THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR YOUR TIME !

This analysis aims to not just reflect on past layoffs, but to empower businesses, investors, and job seekers with strategic foresight.